HIGH PERFORMANCE, APPLIED

# Wanting to improve isn’t a plan.

Two behaviour studies, applied to runbooks.

SWIPE

01

FOLLOW-THROUGH

# Setting the challenge isn’t enough

377 students, 15 weeks. Those who chose challenges and didn’t complete them changed in the opposite direction to the one they wanted.

Hudson and colleagues, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology

02

IF-THEN

# Decide the trigger in advance

Students owed a report about their Christmas Eve, due within two days. With an if–then plan, 71% delivered. Without, 32%.

Gollwitzer and Brandstätter, 1997; 36 students

03

RUNBOOKS

# A runbook is an if-then

If this alert fires, this person does this first. Anything vaguer is a wish, written down.

# 04

THE CAB

## Find the cab

Tharp's ritual was never the workout. It was hailing the cab. In an incident, the cab is declaring it.

Twyla Tharp, The Creative Habit

FREE CHAPTER

# Who Owns What When It Breaks

Read it free

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